Geospatial
Intelligence
Foundation Of Nigeria
(GIFON)

FUNDRAISING AND GRANTS POLICY

1. Introduction

1.1 Policy Statement

GIFON is committed to the highest standards of ethical, transparent, and effective fundraising and grants management. This policy outlines the principles, structures, and procedures to ensure all fundraising and grant acquisition activities support the Foundation's mission and strategic objectives.

1.2 Applicability

This policy applies to all members of the Board of Trustees, Executive Leadership, staff, volunteers, consultants, and partner organizations acting on behalf of GIFON.

2. Strategic Objectives

- Ensure sustainability through diversified funding streams.
- Align fundraising and grant-seeking with strategic priorities.

- Promote accountability, integrity, and donor confidence.
- Institutionalize systems for the proper management of grants and donations.
- Prevent misuse of funds and ensure legal and regulatory compliance.

3. Governance and Oversight

3.1 Fundraising and Grants Committee (FGC)

A standing committee of the Board shall oversee this policy and guide fundraising strategy.

Responsibilities:

- Approve annual fundraising plans and targets.
- Monitor fundraising activities and evaluate performance.
- Review and recommend grant proposals and institutional donors.
- Review all major gifts and high-risk donations.

3.2 Executive Director

The Executive Director shall:

- Provide operational leadership on fundraising initiatives.
- Authorize proposals and donor engagements.

- Ensure compliance with grant and donation terms.

3.3 Finance Department

- Maintain accurate records of funds received and expended.
- Ensure separation of restricted and unrestricted funds.
- Provide timely financial reports to donors and regulators.

4. Fundraising Strategy

4.1 Sources of Funds

GIFON may raise funds through:

- Competitive grants (local, bilateral, multilateral, international).
- Corporate sponsorships and CSR funds.
- Individual donors and philanthropists.
- Membership dues.
- Crowdfunding and online giving platforms.
- Special events and campaigns.
- Strategic partnerships.

4.2 Annual Fundraising Plan

The Executive Management shall develop an annual fundraising plan, including:

- Priority programs and funding gaps.
- Target donor segments.
- Anticipated timelines and costs.
- Campaigns, events, and digital strategies.

5. Proposal Development and Grant Acquisition

5.1 Opportunity Identification

- The Programs and Grants Unit will research relevant funding opportunities.
- Opportunities must align with GIFON's mission and capabilities.

5.2 Proposal Development

- All proposals must be reviewed by the Program Director and Finance Department.
- Proposals shall include objectives, budget, M&E framework, risk assessment, and sustainability plan.

5.3 Pre-Submission Approvals

- Proposals >₦10 million or multiyear grants must be approved by the FGC.
- Letters of Support, MOUs, and co-signatories must be documented.

5.4 Donor Engagement

- Cultivation of relationships must be coordinated and tracked via the CRM system.
- Donor confidentiality and preferences must be respected.

6. Gift Acceptance Policy

GIFON reserves the right to accept or decline any gift or donation.

6.1 Acceptable Gifts:

- Cash, bank transfers, in-kind goods, property, securities, and services.
- Bequests and legacy gifts (subject to legal review).
- Donations made through authorized channels.

6.2 Unacceptable Gifts:

GIFON will not accept gifts that:

- Are inconsistent with its mission or ethics.
- Impose excessive administrative or legal obligations.
- Are derived from illegal or unethical sources.
- Risk reputational harm or conflict of interest.

7. Donor Stewardship and Acknowledgment

- All donations must be receipted and acknowledged within 14 days.
- Annual reports shall include donor recognition (unless anonymity is requested).
- Donor data shall be securely maintained and used only for authorized communication.

8. Grants Management Lifecycle

8.1 Contracting and Compliance

- Every grant must have a signed agreement/MOU stipulating scope, funding, timelines, deliverables, reporting, and exit clauses.
- Grant files must be maintained electronically and physically.
- All donor terms and conditions must be reviewed and communicated to relevant staff.

8.2 Implementation and Monitoring

- Grant-funded projects must be tracked using the M&E framework.
- Performance indicators must align with proposal commitments.
- The Program Manager shall submit periodic technical reports.

8.3 Financial Management

- A separate ledger shall be maintained for each grant.
- Disbursements shall follow internal controls and procurement policy.
- Interim and final financial reports must be submitted per donor schedule.

8.4 Close-Out

- Upon completion, grants must undergo a close-out process including a final report, evaluation, financial reconciliation, and archiving.

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9.1 Due Diligence

GIFON shall conduct due diligence on major donors and partners to avoid:

- Money laundering or illicit finance.
- Politically exposed or controversial donors.
- Ethical, environmental, or legal conflicts.

9.2 Fraud Prevention

- The Finance Department shall implement controls against misuse or misappropriation.
- Suspected fraud must be reported under the Whistleblower Policy.

9.3 Legal Compliance

GIFON must comply with:

- The Companies and Allied Matters Act (CAMA)
- Financial Reporting Council regulations
- EFCC and anti-money laundering laws
- Donor-specific legal requirements

10. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL)

- An annual audit of fundraising and grants shall be conducted by independent auditors.
- Lessons learned from fundraising and grant implementation must be documented.
- Internal and external evaluations will inform strategic adjustments.

11. Communication and Transparency

- Fundraising messages shall be honest, respectful, and not exploitative.
- Annual fundraising and grants performance will be disclosed to stakeholders.
- Social media and public communication must be approved by the Communications Unit.

12. Review and Amendment

This policy shall be reviewed:

- Every 2 years, or
- Upon significant change in law, donor trends, or organizational structure.

Amendments must be approved by the Board of Trustees.